

TROPHY

Baker Leads Both, Wins Neither

Gregg Williams survives his own horror finish to retain the Trophy and Henry Meller's dismal round confirms a third Wooden Spoon, but the afternoon belongs to Jon Baker's remarkable two-competition unravelling.

Gregg Williams had held the TEG 4 Trophy lead since the 2nd hole of Round 1. Fifty-nine holes. At the 7th on PGA Catalunya's Stadium course, Jon Baker took it off him outright. It lasted two holes.

The 9th is the hardest hole on the course. Baker made 10 there, a sextuple bogey, and handed everything back. Williams reclaimed the lead by making a triple bogey at the same hole. That was all the resistance the situation required.

Baker's afternoon had a second act, and it rhymed with the first. He had carried a one-stroke lead into the round for the TEG 4 Green Jacket. He lost it to David Mullin at that same 9th, drew level again at the 16th, and got no closer. Mullin finished the round four clear.

Williams, for his part, did not win this with golf anyone would want filmed. Eleven shots went over the first four holes. From the 6th he played four consecutive holes without a net par. He then gained five shots from the 10th, which suggested a man remembering his profession, before bleeding 14 over the closing five. His eight-stroke lead finished at five. He spent three strokes of it and kept the rest, which is what winning looks like here.

Further back, Henry Meller contributed two large blow-ups and remained precisely where he had been, last, and the Wooden Spoon with him. The gap behind him grew from eight to seventeen. There is no one behind him to catch. He is extending a lead over open ground.

AT A GLANCE
TROPHY WINNER Gregg Williams
GREEN JACKET David Mullin
WOODEN SPOON Henry Meller

ROUND NET VP
DM +4 JB +6 SN +6 GW +9 HM +13
ROUND GROSS
DM +22 JB +27 SN +28 HM +35 GW +41

AFTER R4 • TROPHY
GW 0 JB +5 SN +9 DM +13 HM +30
AFTER R4 • GREEN JACKET
DM +85 JB +89 SN +97 HM +118 GW +128

DAVID MULLIN

Mullin Grinds Out the Jacket Lead

David Mullin's card was the best of the day even with a wobble at the death, and it ended Jon Baker's grip on the TEG 6 Green Jacket.

David Mullin's round at the Stadium course at Camiral began badly and then declined to settle on a direction. Bogey, double bogey, bogey through the first three. A birdie at the 4th halted it. A quadruple bogey seven at the 5th resumed it.

Then came the good part, and it was genuinely good. From the 8th to the 10th he dropped no

gross shots at all and gained three to net par. The 9th, the hardest hole on the course, carried him into outright top spot in the 2013 Green Jacket standings, a lead taken directly off Jon Baker. For three holes, David Mullin was a golfer.

It held until the 14th. A double bogey there, a triple at the 15th, and another double at the 16th

cost seven gross shots to par. The 15th is the easiest hole on the course. Baker drew level with him at the 16th and could do nothing with it. Mullin finished the round in front by four, which he had earned, mostly by other people being worse.

STUART NEUMANN

Neumann's Great Escape

A quintuple bogey at the 3rd looked like it might define Stuart Neumann's day; instead a composed back nine hauled him back into the picture.

Stuart Neumann's final round at the Stadium course came apart at the par-5 3rd, where he signed for a quintuple bogey 10. What followed had a certain grim rhythm. A double bogey at the 4th. Another double at the par-3 5th. A triple bogey at the 6th. Twelve shots gone across those

four holes, and not one net par to interrupt the sequence.

At his lowest point he was 16 shots off the Trophy lead. He then did something almost nobody managed all day. He stopped. The closing stretch brought him back to 9 behind Williams, a recovery of 7 from the bottom of it.

It was never going to reach the podium, with Williams's cushion over the field closing at 5. But the back nine turned a write-off into a scorecard he could hand in without commentary. The front nine remains on his record, permanently, in ink.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 6, Round 4